

an up-down pattern. What interests me is that Jared says this shape has contributed to the history of civilizations.

When the age of agriculture happened, we looked to expand acres of land into edible crops. What's often spoken is: agriculture was done around river banks. What was not spoken was: people found it easier to plant crops in close vicinity where the temperature and conditions did not vary. This meant planting crops across the latitude, through tons of land where humidity, temperatures and rainfall could be replicated. For example, if growing wheat was possible in Sindh province, it could be done in Myanmar as well. But it couldn't be replicated easily in New Zealand as it posed new technological questions, for which we weren't ready.

All this meant we could bring-up similar crops across vast areas and did not need new inventions. The entire region from the Middle East stretching to Far East Cambodia through India could advocate rice as a chief crop. But if you traveled through the longitude, the climate varied greatly. Picture how contrasting Srinagar and Chennai are across the seasons. This led to more people across continents which were horizontally spread like Asia, Europe and Middle East.

Mass food cultivation meant civilization grew at a rapid pace and people didn't die of hunger and isolation. Although people tried to spread, early civilizations occurred only in Indus, Mesopotamia, Egypt, Persia, China and Greece as they spread across river beds with a similar, ideal environment.



Try to grow cotton in the Himalayan wilderness. No matter what you try and be the most talented, some things do not happen. Let's dive into the topic of business. You can place a room chock full of geniuses who on an IQ test would score 200 each but the organization will conclusively fail, if you set the wrong environment.

Take the hedge fund, **Long Term Capital Management** as an example. Led by geniuses across domains of investing, economics and mathematics who designed infallible algorithms, worked out every probability of failure, covered every base and still ended in an uproaring failure. With a combined experience of 350 years in the field, these geniuses failed because they forgot to set up one thing that mattered most: environment. When they